

FLEET RULE OF THE ROAD TEST FOR SEP 18

This test is based on The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea (IRPCS) (1972) with amendments in force up to December 2009 as detailed in "A Seaman's Guide Pocket Book of The International Regulations for Preventing Collisions at Sea" (BR 453 Supp), ATP1(G) Vol II, IALA Maritime Buoyage System (NP735) and the Mariners Handbook (NP100).

The test is designed to be given to any Warfare Officer, Deck Officer, Officer undertaking bridge watch-keeping duties or Young Officer/Cadet. The test should be administered under written exam conditions, the results should be recorded in the OOW training records for inspection by FOST Navigation Staff. The exam should take no longer than 1hr.

In this test, any change in the status of the ship or of the environment will be indicated in the script. Rules 1 to 19, 34, 35 and Annex IV must be known instinctively for instant application. A thorough knowledge of the other rules is required. The pass mark is 90%.

PART 1

1. The term "vessels restricted in their ability to manoeuvre" shall include but not be limited to... what? (R.3g) **(3)**

2. What lights would such a vessel (over 50m in length) display while underway at night with an obstruction on her port side? (r.27) **(4)**

3. Is the vessel required to keep a look-out? If so, how shall it be done? (R.5) **(2)**

4. How would you define Restricted visibility? (R.3I) **(1)**

5. Why do vessels proceed at a safe speed? (R.6) **(2)**

6. What factors shall all vessels consider when determining a safe speed? (R.6a) **(3)**
7. In determining if risk of collision exists what considerations shall be among those taken into account? (R.7d) **(2)**
8. What are the sound signals for a vessel not under command? (R.35c) **(2)**
9. What is meant by the term “prolonged blast?” (R.32c) **(1)**
10. What should a vessel do when nearing a bend or intervening obstruction in a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9f) **(2)**
11. Describe the sound signals a vessel intending to overtake another on her port side in a narrow channel or fairway should make. (R.9e(i) R.34c(i)) **(1)**
12. What sound signals would the vessel to be overtaken make if in agreement? (R.9e(i) R.34 c(ii)) **(1)**

13. What is meant by the windward side of a sailing vessel? (R.12b) **(2)**

14. When two Sailing Vessels, each with the wind on a different side, are approaching one another so as to involve risk of collision, which shall keep out of the way? (R.12a) **(1)**

15. When two Sailing Vessels, each with the wind on the same side, are approaching one another so as to involve risk of collision, which shall keep out of the way? (R.12a) **(1)**

Part 1 ____/28

PART 2

You are the OOW in HMS WESTMINSTER (length 137m) sailing from alongside Portsmouth to conduct training in the SCXA. The weather is fine with good visibility and you are looking forward to getting underway after a period of maintenance alongside.

Before sailing, as you've not been to sea for a prolonged period, the CO decides to test your knowledge of the COLREGs

16. He asks you if, while in the harbour, the rules apply and who has authority to overrule them? (R.1b) **(2)**

17. He then asks your YO at what point will you be considered underway and why? (R3i) **(1)**

18. Finally, he asks, should you suffer a machinery breakdown what would you be considered, why and what shapes would you display to indicate this? (R.3f R.27a) **(2)**

Satisfied with your answers, and knowing the ship is ready in all respects, the CO decides to proceed to sea.

19. As you approach the exit you sight a ferry crossing ahead of you, currently at Green 30, 9c and with a CPA of 1c on your starboard bow. As you are constrained within the narrow channel, what action would you expect of the ferry and why? (R.9d) **(2)**

20. The ferry is now at 5c and has taken no action. What sound signal could you use? (R.34d) **(1)**

21. The ferry continues to cross ahead of you. At what point may you take action? (R17aii) **(2)**

22. At what point shall you take action? (R.17b) **(2)**

23. Is there anything that can exonerate the ferry from the consequences of its actions? (R.2a) **(2)**

You reduce speed to allow the ferry to pass ahead of you at a safe distance. Your departure proceeds without further incident. SSD are fallen out and you remain on the Bridge for the first watch. Soon, visibility unexpectedly reduces. You reduce to a safe speed and carry out all the necessary actions.

24. Your port lookout reports one long blast on your port side. The signal does not tie in with any radar contact. What is required by the rules? (R.19e) **(2)**

25. Anti-col reports a radar contact bearing 200°T at 2nm with a CPA of 1nm on your port side. The bearing ties in with one prolonged blast reported by the port lookout (the signals are heard at 2 minutes intervals). What type of vessel could this be? (R.35a) **(1)**

26. You detect a contact on radar fine on the starboard bow at 5nm. Describe your actions and what you must avoid? (R19d) **(3)**

27. You finally pass this contact – a power driven vessel of at least 100m. Describe the lights, arcs of visibility and minimum detection ranges you expect her to display?(R21 & R22a) **(6)**

Part 2 ____/26
Total ____/54

PART 1 - ANSWERS

1. The term “vessels restricted in their ability to manoeuvre” shall include but not be limited to... what? (R.3g) **(3)**

1/2 mark for each

- i. a vessel engaged in laying, service or picking up a navigation mark, submarine cable or pipeline;
- ii. a vessel engaged in dredging, surveying or underwater operations;
- iii. a vessel engaged in replenishment of transferring persons, provisions or cargo while underway;
- iv. a vessel engaged in the launching or recovery of aircraft;
- v. a vessel engaged in mine clearance operations;
- vi. a vessel engaged in a towing operation such as severely restricts the towing vessel and her tow in their ability to deviate from their course

2. What lights would such a vessel (over 50m in length) display while underway at night with an obstruction on her port side? (R.27) **(4)**

Three all-round lights in a vertical line where they can best be seen. The highest and lowest of these lights shall be red and the middle light shall be white;

When making way through the water, a masthead light or lights, sidelights and a sternlight, in addition to the lights prescribed in sub-paragraph (i);

Two all-round red lights or two balls in a vertical line to indicate the side on which the obstruction exists;

Two all-round green lights or two diamonds in a vertical line to indicate the side on which another vessel may pass;

3. Is the vessel required to keep a look-out? If so, how shall it be done? (R.5) **(2)**

Yes. Every vessel shall at all times maintain a proper look-out by sight and hearing as well as all available means appropriate in the prevailing circumstances and conditions so as to make a full appraisal of the situation and of the risk of collision.

4. How would you define Restricted visibility? (R.3l) **(1)**

The term “restricted visibility” means any condition in which visibility is restricted by fog, mist, falling snow, heavy rainstorms, sandstorms or any other similar causes.

5. Why do vessels proceed at a safe speed? (R.6) **(2)**

Every vessel shall at all times proceed at a safe speed so that she can take proper and effective action to avoid collision and be stopped within a distance appropriate to the prevailing circumstances and conditions.

6. What factors shall all vessels consider when determining a safe speed? (R.6a) **(3)**

½ mark for each

- (i) the state of visibility;**
- (ii) the traffic density including concentrations of fishing vessels or any other vessels;**
- (iii) the manoeuvrability of the vessel with special reference to stopping distance and turning ability in the prevailing conditions;**

- (iv) at night the presence of background light such as from shore lights or from back scatter of her own lights;
- (v) the state of wind, sea and current, and the proximity of navigational hazards;
- (vi) the draught in relation to the available depth of water.

7. In determining if risk of collision exists what considerations shall be among those taken into account? (R.7d) **(2)**

In determining if risk of collision exists the following considerations shall be among those taken into account:

- (i) such risk shall be deemed to exist if the compass bearing of an approaching vessel does not appreciably change;**
- (ii) such risk may sometimes exist even when an appreciable bearing change is evident, particularly when approaching a very large vessel or a tow or when approaching a vessel at close range.**

8. What are the sound signals for a vessel not under command? (R.35c) **(2)**

A vessel not under command, a vessel restricted in her ability to manoeuvre, a vessel constrained by her draught, a sailing vessel, a vessel engaged in fishing and a vessel engaged in towing or pushing another vessel shall, instead of the signals prescribed in paragraphs (a) or (b) of this Rule, sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes three blasts in succession, namely one prolonged followed by two short blasts.

9. What is meant by the term “prolonged blast?” (R.32c) **(1)**

The term “prolonged blast” means a blast of from four to six seconds’ duration.

10. What should a vessel do when nearing a bend or intervening obstruction in a narrow channel or fairway? (R.9f) **(2)**

A vessel nearing a bend or an area of a narrow channel or fairway where other vessels may be obscured by an intervening obstruction shall navigate with particular alertness and caution and shall sound the appropriate signal prescribed in rule 34(e)

11. Describe the sound signals a vessel intending to overtake another on her port side in a narrow channel or fairway should make. (R.9e(i) R.34c(ii)) **(1)**

Two prolonged blasts followed by two short blasts

12. What sound signals would the vessel to be overtaken make if in agreement? (R.9e(i) R.34 c(ii)) **(1)**

One prolonged, one short, one prolonged and one short blast, in that order.

13. What is meant by the windward side of a sailing vessel? (R.12b) **(2)**

For the purposes of this Rule the windward side shall be deemed to be the side opposite to that on which the mainsail is carried or, in the case of a square-rigged vessel, the side opposite to that on which the largest fore-and-aft sail is carried.

14. When two Sailing Vessels, each with the wind on a different side, are approaching one another so as to involve risk of collision, which has right of way? (R.12a) **(1)**

When each has the wind on a different side, the vessel which has the wind on the port side shall keep out of the way of the other

15. When two Sailing Vessels, each with the wind on the same side, are approaching one another so as to involve risk of collision, which shall keep out of the way? (R.12a) **(1)**

when both have the wind on the same side, the vessel which is to windward shall keep out of the way of the vessel which is to leeward

Part 1 ____/28

PART 2- ANSWERS

You are the OOW in HMS WESTMINSTER (length 137m) sailing from alongside Portsmouth to conduct training in the SCXA. The weather is fine with good visibility and you are looking forward to getting underway after a period of maintenance alongside.

Before sailing, as you've not been to sea for a prolonged period, the CO decides to test your knowledge of the COLREGs

16. He asks you if, while in the harbour, the rules apply and who has authority to overrule them? (R.1b) **(2)**

Nothing in these Rules shall interfere with the operation of special rules made by an appropriate authority for roadsteads, harbours, rivers, lakes or inland waterways connected with the high seas and navigable by seagoing vessels. Such special rules shall conform as closely as possible to these Rules.

17. He then asks your YO at what point will you be considered underway and why? (R.3i) **(1)**

The word "underway" means that a vessel is not at anchor, or made fast to the shore, or aground.

18. Finally, he asks, should you suffer a machinery breakdown what would you be considered, why and what shapes would you display to indicate this? (R.3f R.27a) **(2)**

The term "vessel not under command" means a vessel which through some exceptional circumstance is unable to manoeuvre as required by these Rules and is therefore unable to keep out of the way of another vessel.

A vessel not under command shall exhibit two balls or similar shapes in a vertical line where they can best be seen

Satisfied with your answers, and knowing the ship is ready in all respects, the CO decides to proceed to sea.

19. As you approach the exit you sight a ferry crossing ahead of you, currently at Green 30, 9c and with a CPA of 1c on your starboard bow. As you are constrained within the narrow channel, what action would you expect of the ferry and why? (R.9d) **(2)**

A vessel shall not cross a narrow channel or fairway if such crossing impedes the passage of a vessel which can safely navigate only within such channel or fairway.

20. The ferry is now at 5c and has taken no action. What sound signal could you use? (R.34d) **(1)**

When vessels in sight of one another are approaching each other and from any cause either vessel fails to understand the intentions or actions of the other, or is in doubt whether sufficient action is being taken by the other to avoid collision, the vessel in doubt shall immediately indicate such doubt by giving at least five short and rapid blasts on the whistle. Such signal may be supplemented by a light signal of at least five short and rapid flashes.

21. The ferry continues to cross ahead of you. At what point may you take action? (R17aii)

The latter vessel may however take action to avoid collision by her manoeuvre alone, as soon as it becomes apparent to her that the vessel required to keep out of the way is not taking appropriate action in compliance with these Rules.

22. At what point shall you take action? (R.17b) **(2)**

When, from any cause, the vessel required to keep her course and speed finds herself so close that collision cannot be avoided by the action of the give-way vessel alone, she shall take such action as will best aid to avoid collision.

23. Is there anything that can exonerate the ferry from the consequences of its actions? (R.2a) **(2)**

Nothing in these Rules shall exonerate any vessel, or the owner, master or crew thereof, from the consequences of any neglect to comply with these Rules or of the neglect of any precaution which may be required by the ordinary practice of seamen, or by the special circumstances of the case.

24. Your port lookout reports one long blast on your port side. The signal does not tie in with any radar contact. What do the rules require? (R.19e) **(2)**

Except where it has been determined that a risk of collision does not exist, every vessel which hears apparently forward of her beam the fog signal of another vessel, or which cannot avoid a close-quarters situation with another vessel forward of her beam, shall reduce her speed to the minimum at which she can be kept on her course. She shall if necessary take all her way off and in any event navigate with extreme caution until danger of collision is over

25. Anti-col reports a radar contact bearing 200°T at 2nm with a CPA of 1nm on your port side. The bearing ties in with one prolonged blast reported by the port lookout (the signals are heard at 2 minutes intervals). What type of vessel could this be? (R.35a) **(1)**

A power-driven vessel making way through the water shall sound at intervals of not more than 2 minutes one prolonged blast

26. You detect a contact on radar fine on the starboard bow at 5nm. Describe your actions and what you must avoid? (R19d) **(3)**

A vessel which detects by radar alone the presence of another vessel shall determine if a close quarters situation is developing and/or risk of collision exists. If so, she shall take avoiding action in ample time, provided that when such action consists of an alteration of course, so far as possible the following shall be avoided:

- (i) an alteration of course to port for a vessel forward of the beam, other than for a vessel being overtaken;**
- (ii) an alteration of course towards a vessel abeam or abaft the beam**

27. You finally pass this contact – a power driven vessel of at least 100m. Describe the lights, arcs of visibility and minimum detection ranges you expect her to display?(R21 & R22a) (6)

“Masthead light” means a white light placed over the fore and aft centreline of the vessel showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 225 degrees and so fixed as to show the light from right ahead to 22.5 degrees abaft the beam on either side of the vessel.
“Sidelights” means a green light on the starboard side and a red light on the port side each showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 112.5 degrees and so fixed as to show the light from right ahead to 22.5 degrees abaft the beam on its respective side. In a vessel of less than 20 metres in length the sidelights may be combined in one lantern carried on the fore and aft centreline of the vessel.
“Sternlight” means a white light placed as nearly as practicable at the stern showing an unbroken light over an arc of the horizon of 135 degrees and so fixed as to show the light 67.5 degrees from right aft on each side of the vessel.

The lights prescribed in these Rules shall have an intensity as specified in section 8 of Annex I to these Regulations so as to be visible at the following minimum ranges:
In vessels of 50 metres or more in length:
a masthead light, 6 miles;
a sidelight, 3 miles;
a sternlight, 3 miles;

Part 2 ____/26
Total ____/54